Biology and radios

Can a biologist fix a radio?—Or, what I learned while studying apoptosis

CANCER CELL : SEPTEMBER 2002 · VOL. 2 · COPYRIGHT © 2002 CELL PRESS

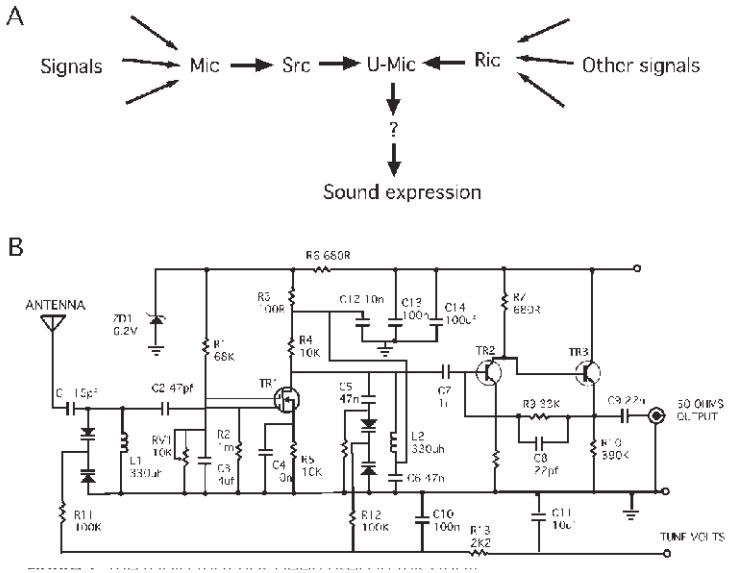


Figure 3. The tools used by biologists and engineers to describe processes of interest

A: The biologistís view of a radio. See Figure 2 and text for description of the indicated components. **B:** The engineerís view of a radio. (Please note that the circuit diagram presented is not that of the radio used in the study. The diagram of the radio was lost, which, in part, explains why the radio remains broken.)

See text for description of the indicated components. The inset is an enlarged portion of the radio. The horizontal arrows indicate tunable components.

- We don’t know all the parts.
- We don’t know how they are connected.
- Many parts fit into multiple circuits.
- We don’t know the design principles.
- Lack of common language(s).